

Incident handler's journal

Date: October 15, 2025	**Entry:** #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident pertaining to a small U.S. health care clinic.
Tool(s) used	N/A
The 5 W's	• **Who**: An organized group of unethical hackers • **What**: A ransomware incident occured. Several employees reported that they were unable to use their computers to access files like medical records. They also reported that a ransom note was displayed on their computers. • **When**: Tuesday morning, at approximately 9:00 AM • **Where**: At a small U.S. health care clinic specializing in primary care services. • **Why**: The incident occurred because attackers were able to gain access into the company's network by using targeted phishing emails.The phishing emails contained a malicious attachment that installed malware on the employee's computer once it was downloaded. Once the attackers gained access, they deployed their ransomware, which encrypted critical files.
Additional notes	• The attack seems to be primarily due to financial reasons as the attackers left a ransom note demanding a large sum of money. • The company should integrate training to teach employees how to identify phishing emails. Company execs could even send out fake phishing emails to see which of their employees may need additional training.

	• Would it be wise for the company to pay the ransom?